Vidhayak Dal (SVD) that took power as the first non-Congress regime in the state under Govind Narayan Singh.[47] A founding vice-president of the BJP in 1980, she was the only woman office-bearer in the party's central leadership at the time. Later, she played a big part in the Ram Janmabhoomi movement.

Jayawantiben Mehta, appointed as National Executive member, was a Gujarati from Bombay who first became a Jan Sangh corporator, then an MLA and finally a three-time MP from Mumbai South, where she felled Congress heavyweight Murli Deora in parliamentary elections in 1996 as well as 1999. Mohinder Kaur, the third female appointee on the party's apex body, was a Sikh woman leader from Delhi. Sumatibai Suklikar from Nagpur had fought and lost several municipal elections in the 1960s. Finally, Dr Kamla Verma, president of the BJP's Haryana wing, had been with the party since its Jan Sangh days and had served as a minister in the Lok Dal–BJP coalition government headed by Chaudhary Devi Lal and the Haryana Vikas Party–BJP government of Bhajan Lal. While Suklikar was appointed 'special invitee' to the National Executive, Verma was both a 'permanent invitee' and president of the party's Haryana unit.

This founding women cohort was thereafter joined by Sushma Swaraj, a lawyer who started her political career in the 1970s Navnirman movement and became a cabinet minister in the Janata Party government in Haryana in 1977;[48] Sumitra Mahajan, from a Vaishya family in Indore, who started as a corporator; Uma Bharti, who started as a young prodigy singing religious texts in Tikamgarh (Madhya Pradesh) before becoming a major figure in the Ram Temple movement and an OBC leader; and Vasundhara Raje (Vijaya Raje Scindia's daughter and titular queen of Dholpur). Swaraj became the BJP's first female chief minister (Delhi) in 1998 and Leader of the Opposition (2009–2014). Mahajan went on to become the party's longest-serving female Lok Sabha MP (1989–2019) and India's second woman speaker in the Lok Sabha (2014–2019). Vasundhara Raje eventually became the party's first female chief minister in Rajasthan (2003–2008 and 2013–2018).

Despite such beginnings, the BJP failed to attract women voters through the early 1980s. The Mahila Morcha's political outreach to